

Clean versus Functional Code in Scholarly Digital Editing

The Case of the Samuel Beckett Digital Manuscript Project

Wout Dillen



Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

Digital Paradigm: Content≠Appearance.

(Sahle 2013 (2), 159-160)

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

```
<seg n="MS-HRC-SB-5-10,[0041]" zone="zonets_7"
xml:id="inntsd0e439"><del type="crossOut" hand="#SB" resp="#SW"
rend="blueblack ink">At</del> <add rend="blueblack ink" resp="#SW"
hand="#SB" place="supralinear">In</add> <lb rend="it"/> the <del
type="crossOut" hand="#SB" resp="#SW" rend="blueblack
ink">outset</del> <add rend="blueblack ink" resp="#SW" hand="#SB"
place="supralinear">beginning</add>.</seg>
```

(Beckett 2014, sentence 0041 in MS-HRC-SB-5-10; color added)

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

~~At~~ ^{In} the outset beginning.

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

In the beginning.

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

~~At~~ ^{In} the outset ^{beginning} .

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

At ^{In [place = supralinear]} the outset ^{beginning [place = supralinear]}.

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

is different. They will come back to me as I go along, and how to shit on them, sooner or later, like a bird, without ~~emitting any~~ exception. That is an easy thing to say soon said. The fact would seem to be, if in my situation one may speak of facts, ~~it~~ not only that I shall have to speak of things of which I cannot speak, but also, which is even more interesting, but also that I, which is even more interesting, that I shall have to, I forget, no matter. And yet I am obliged to speak. I shall never be silent. Never.



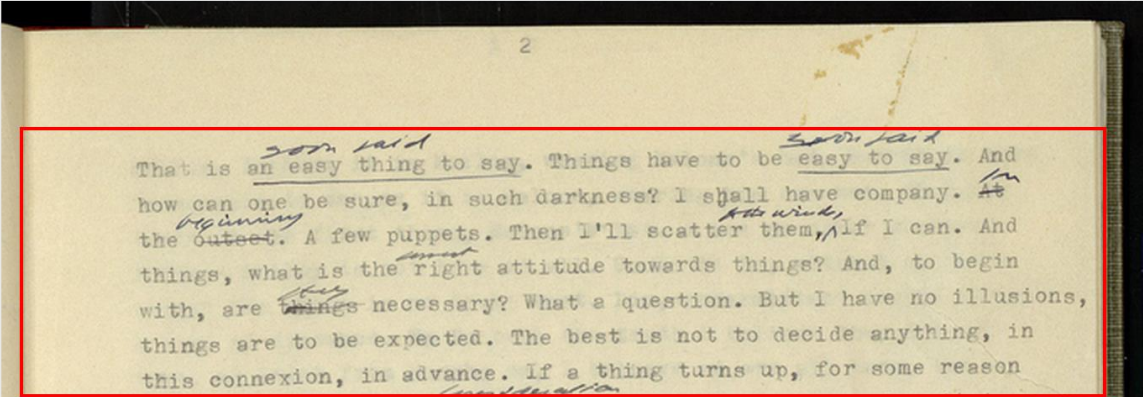
I shall not be alone, at the outset in the beginning. ~~Of course I am.~~ I am of course alone. Alone.
[p. 02r] That is an easy thing to say soon said. Things have to be easy to say soon said. And how can one be sure, in such darkness? I s^hall have company. ~~At~~ In the outset beginning. A few puppets. Then I'll scatter them, to the winds, If I can. And things, what is the ^{right} correct attitude towards things? And, to begin with, are ~~things~~ they necessary? What a question. But I have no illusions, things are to be expected. The best is not to decide anything, in this connexion, in advance. If a thing turns up, for some reason or another, take it into ~~account~~ consideration. Where there are people, it is said, there are things. Does this mean that when you admit the former you must admit the latter? ~~It remains to be seen~~ Time will tell. The thing to avoid, I don't know why, is the spirit of system. People with things, people without things, things without people, what does it matter, ~~it will not take me long to scatter them.~~ I'm confident I can ~~soon~~ scatter them when I choose, to the winds. I don't see how. The best

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

[< PREV](#)[MS-HRC-SB-5-10](#)[NEXT >](#)

[<PREV](#)[page 02r](#)[NEXT>](#)

[image](#) | [zoom image](#) | [image/text](#) | [text](#) | [document description](#)



2

That is ^{soon said} an easy thing to say. Things have to be ^{soon said} easy to say. And how can one be sure, in such darkness? I shall have company. ^{At} the ^{beginning} outset. A few puppets. Then I'll scatter them, ^{to the winds,} if I can. And things, what is the ^{correct} right attitude towards things? And, to begin with, are ^{they} things necessary? What a question. But I have no illusions, things are to be expected. The best is not to decide anything, in this connexion, in advance. If a thing turns up, for some reason

☒ Segment 1

That is an easy thing to say ^{soon said}. Things have to be easy to say ^{soon said}. And how can one be sure, in such darkness? I shall have company. ^{At} In the ^{beginning} outset. A few puppets. Then I'll scatter them, ^{to the winds,} If I can. And things, what is the ^{correct} right attitude towards things? And, to begin with, are ^{they} things necessary? What a question. But I have no illusions, things are to be expected. The best is not to decide anything, in this connexion, in advance.

No, ~~I am only joking.~~ ^{no danger.} Of that.

Malone is there. Of his mortal liveliness little trace ^{remains} survives.

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

- ☐ ☐ *L'Innommable* Segment 41, version 2 (Minuit 1953)

Pour commencer.

- ☐ ☐ *The Unnamable* Segment 41, version 3 (MS-HRC-SB-5-9-1, p. 02r)

The chronology of the sentence versions relating to the first 23 pages of this manuscript differs from the chronology of the rest of the text. For a more detailed analysis: click [here](#).

In the beginning.



- ☐ ☐ *The Unnamable* Segment 41, version 4 (MS-HRC-SB-5-10, p. 02r)

The chronology of the sentence versions relating to the first 24 pages of this typescript differs from the chronology of the rest of the text. For a more detailed analysis: click [here](#).

At In the outset beginning.



- ☐ ☐ *The Unnamable* Segment 41, version 5 (Spectrum)

At the outset.

- ☐ ☐ *The Unnamable* Segment 41, version 6 (MS-WU-MSS008-3-71, p. 02r)

In the beginning.



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[< back to Synoptic Sentence View](#)

[prev](#) | [next](#)

CollateX results: [0041]

variant, invariant.

Doubleclick or select a word to highlight it in the Synoptic Sentence View.

☒ [Version 1](#) ☒ [Version 2](#) ☒ [Version 3](#) ☒ [Version 4](#) ☒ [Version 5](#)

Version 1: MS-HRC-SB-5-9-1		In	the		beginning	.
Version 2: MS-HRC-SB-5-10	At	In	the	outset	beginning	.
Version 3: MS-Spectrum	At		the	outset		.
Version 4: MS-WU-MSS008-3-71		In	the		beginning	.
Version 5: MS-1958		In	the		beginning	.



Collatex is a software collation tool developed by the Interedition Development Group. Go to <http://collatex.net/> for further information.

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  .
</seg>
<seg n="MS-HRC-SB-5-10,[0042]" zone="zonets_7" xml:id="inntsd0e454">A few puppets.</seg>
- <seg n="MS-HRC-SB-5-10,[0043]" zone="zonets_7" xml:id="inntsd0e457">
  Then I'll scatter them
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Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

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<seg n="MS-HRC-SB-3-10,[1524]" xml:id="ms1_1d0e22069"
zone="zonems238"><del type="crossOut" hand="#SB" rend="blueblack
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(Beckett 2014, sentence 1524 in MS-HRC-SB-3-10; color added)

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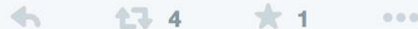
Should we cater to every user?

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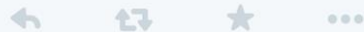
Cornelis J. Schilt @KeesJanSchilt · Oct 23

Schaßan: "Editors must not recode what THEY are not interested in" ? Que?
Are we again limiting our readers/users? #teiconf2014



Torsten Schaßan @schassan · Oct 23

@KeesJanSchilt Who will pay the editor to encode more than his view???
#TEIConf2014



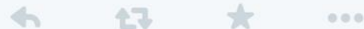
Cornelis J. Schilt @KeesJanSchilt · Oct 24

.@schassan I understand \$\$\$ are involved, but shouldn't this be in the 1st place
about editorial principles? #teiconf2014



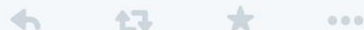
Elena Pierazzo @epierazzo · Oct 24

@KeesJanSchilt @schassan yes: about editorial principles, so what editors are
interested in! the rest is costly guesswork #TEIConf2014



Cornelis J. Schilt @KeesJanSchilt · Oct 24

@epierazzo @schassan I say: encode as much as possible and provide the
reader with all possible choices #TEIConf2014



Elena Pierazzo @epierazzo · Oct 24

.@KeesJanSchilt @schassan I say encode as much as you need, and leave the
user enhance it! humility as well as pragmatic #TEIConf2014



Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

Adequacy is a criterion of incompleteness: it recognizes that there is no limit to the amount of editorial and bibliographical labor that could be expended on a text, but stresses that **to achieve the practical end of completing an edition or an encoding that is useful for particular scholarly purposes, some restriction of scope is always necessary.**

(Lavagnino 1996, 71; emphasis added)

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE



Anne Baillot
@AnneBaillot



Following

Debate whether XML should be generally humanly readable. The TEI fraction reacts strongly #ests2013 #youbet



Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

Human readability ≠ Legibility

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

Not all human readable code is meant to be
read by humans

=> Functional Code

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

```
<div xml:id="MS-HRC-SB-3-10-01v" n="01v" type="page"
rend="coordinates"> <img width="680" height="1097"/> <div
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type="paragraph"><left>42</left><top>80</top><width>634</width>
<height>117</height></div>
```

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

(pause. briefly.)

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

(`<seg>pause.</seg> <seg>briefly.</seg>`)

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

<stage>(<seg>pause.</seg> <seg>briefly.</seg>)</stage>

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

<supplied>

<supplied> signifies text supplied by the transcriber or editor for any reason, typically because the original cannot be read because of physical damage or loss to the original.

(TEI P5; color added)

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

<stage>(<seg><supplied>(</supplied>pause.</seg> <seg>briefly.<supplied>)</supplied> </seg>)</stage>

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

((pause. briefly))

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

if a transcription is really meant to be read as an editorial interpretation of a document's text, this implies that **the reader should be able to reconstruct that text as well as possible on the basis of the transcription alone**

Clean vs Functional Code in SDE

Functional code stands in the way of such a reconstruction

Legibility ↓ Accuracy ↓ Interoperability ↓